MONTHLY UPDATE

Madagascar: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Regional collaboration

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity

DPI
Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

TECHNOLOGY
ICT Industry

CAPACITY
Literacy · Training and skills

INCLUSION
Access to services · Digital divides

DATA
Open data

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

OPEN GOVERNMENT PARTNERSHIP READHESION

- **Gouvernement ouvert : Madagascar à trois points du seuil requis** — Midi Madagasikara, 9 October 2026

  Madagascar scores 9 of 16 points against the 12 it needs to rejoin the Open Government Partnership, which it first joined in 2016. A colloquium is drafting commitments for a national action plan for 2026 to 2030.

Legislation and regulation

CYBERCRIME BILL OVERHAULING THE 2014 LAW

- **Madagascar actualise son arsenal face à la montée des risques numériques** — We are Tech, 1 September 2026

  Madagascar is overhauling its 2014 cybercrime law, with judicial cooperation across borders the central problem where offenders and evidence sit in several countries at once.

- **Cybercriminalite : l''etau se resserre autour des faux comptes** — L'Express de Madagascar, 2 September 2026

Madagascar's National Assembly was due to vote on a bill reforming the 2014 cybercrime law. Article 17 sets two to five years' prison and fines of Ar5m to Ar50m for running fake-account networks or deceiving people with fake identities, doubled for organised groups. Article 52 makes group administrators and resharers liable for manifestly illegal content they knowingly leave online.

- **Loi sur la cybercriminalite : l''Etat renforce les controles alors que l''acces a l''information reste en suspens** — Madagascar-Tribune, 3 September 2026

  Madagascar's cybercrime bill 042/2026 was due before the National Assembly for adoption. It creates a digital investigation unit, Upin, whose article 75 grants round-the-clock direct technical access to operators' and internet providers' systems, with traceability and judicial safeguards. The paper notes that the access-to-information bill 017/2025 remains adjourned in committee, its plenary debate postponed indefinitely.

- **Loi sur la cybercriminalite : une police numerique au coeur du dispositif** — L'Express de Madagascar, 3 September 2026

  Madagascar's cybercrime bill, due before the National Assembly on 4 September 2026, creates a Digital Protection and Investigation Unit (Upin) as a public body. Article 75 gives it permanent technical access to the systems of operators and service providers holding data needed for investigations. A companion electronic communications bill places all data processed in Madagascar under the state's exclusive jurisdiction.

- **Madagascar strengthens trust architecture for national digital ID** — Biometric Update, 4 September 2026

  Madagascar's government presented two cybercrime bills to parliament on 28 August 2026, one updating the national cybercrime framework and creating a digital investigation unit (UPIN), the other authorising ratification of the UN Convention against Cybercrime. More than six million people had enrolled in the biometric national ID by June, against a target of 12 million and a production goal of 100,000 cards a day.

- **Cybersurveillance !** — Newsmada, 5 September 2026

  Commentary on the deferral reads the contested articles as written to suit the state's own control interests rather than to fight cybercrime, singling out the surveillance powers the bill would create. The Assembly's president said he did not care to imagine what would have followed had the two lead texts not been deferred.

- **Tsimbazaza : les deputes ajournent le vote du projet de loi sur la cybercriminalite** — L'Express de Madagascar, 5 September 2026

  The National Assembly deferred five bills to a later session rather than vote them, the recast cybercrime law and the electronic communications and digital infrastructure bill first among them; deputies said they needed longer on texts turning on both security imperatives and fundamental freedoms. No resumed date is set.

- **SESSION EXTRAORDINAIRE - Le texte sur la cybercriminalité absent de l'ordre du jour** — L'Express de Madagascar, 17 September 2026

  Madagascar's cybercrime bill was left off the agenda of the extraordinary session that opened on 17 September, which lists seventeen bills over twelve days; the companion bill on electronic communications and digital infrastructure is absent too. Both had their votes deferred to a later session in the closing hours of the previous extraordinary session, and an extraordinary session's agenda is set by presidential decree.

BILL ON ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS AND DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Loi sur la cybercriminalite : une police numerique au coeur du dispositif** — L'Express de Madagascar, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

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  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **Madagascar Has 80% 4G Coverage, Yet Mobile Internet Remains Out of Reach for Most** — Ecofin Agency, 2 October 2026

  Madagascar's bill on electronic communications and digital infrastructure, submitted on 28 August, still waits for examination by the National Assembly. The article sets it against a market where 4G covers about 80 per cent of the population while mobile internet use stays low.

DIGITAL BILLS BEFORE THE EXTRAORDINARY SESSION

- **SESSION EXTRAORDINAIRE - Le texte sur la cybercriminalité absent de l'ordre du jour** — L'Express de Madagascar, 17 September 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

UNITED NATIONS CONVENTION AGAINST CYBERCRIME

- **Madagascar strengthens trust architecture for national digital ID** — Biometric Update, 4 September 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA DRC MAURITIUS RWANDA TUNISIA GLOBAL

  Angola, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda and Tunisia are among the 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration on space-based scientific data published by France's presidency on 10 September 2026. It commits signatories to open access to satellite observation data, save for exceptions such as security and personal data, and to common exchange standards.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SATELLITE CONNECTIVITY FOR TEN ENCLAVED ZONES (DECIM)

- **Fifandraisan-davitra sy ny nomerika : tolotra maimaimpoana i Madagasikara** — Tia Tanindrazana, 8 September 2026

  Madagascar's digital development and telecoms ministry obtained 300 Starlink kits with free internet service under a cooperation with Starlink, reported on 8 September 2026, to connect remote areas. It follows free internet installed at the main public universities. No duration or cost of the free service is given.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

IZAHO TOKANA 2.0 MASS BIOMETRIC REGISTRATION

- **Enregistrement biométrique – « Izaho tokana 2.0 » entre dans sa deuxième phase** — Moov Madagascar, 17 September 2026

  Madagascar's interior minister launched the second phase of the Izaho tokana 2.0 identity programme, mass biometric enrolment with a unique identification number for each person, at Anosy on 16 September 2026, National Identity Day. The World Bank funds the operation through the DECIM project, and an operational command centre for enrolment was opened. No enrolment targets or costs are given.

- **IDENTITÉ NUMÉRIQUE – « Izaho tokana 2.0 » cible plus de 10 millions de citoyens pour sa deuxième phase** — 2424.mg, 17 September 2026

  Madagascar's interior ministry launched the second phase of its biometric enrolment operation, Izaho tokana 2.0, on national identity day, aiming to register more than 10 million adults by July 2027. Nearly 5 million people were enrolled in the first phase from April to June 2026, against a target of 2 million, and 1,000 more enrolment kits have been added.

PRODIGY BIOMETRIC NATIONAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **État civil : L'OIF aux côtés de Madagascar pour la Journée Nationale de l'Identité** — Midi Madagasikara, 17 September 2026

  Madagascar's National Identity Day, institutionalised by a 2024 decree, carried a high-level conference of more than 150 people preparing the 2027-2036 civil-registration decade. Phase II of the biometric enrolment operation was launched on the second day under the World Bank's digital connectivity project, with no target or coverage figure given for it.

Digital Payments and Fintech

DEVELOPMENT BANK AND TELECOMS GROUP DIGITAL FINANCE PROGRAMME FOR WOMEN-LED BUSINESSES

- **African Development Bank and AXIAN Launch Digital Finance Programme to Support 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — African Development Bank Group (distributed by APO Group), 2 September 2026
  TANZANIA SENEGAL TOGO COMOROS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN Group launched a programme on 2 September 2026 to offer digital loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile money platforms to 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal. A second component will train 25,000 women in those countries plus Togo and the Comoros. No committed amount is stated.

- **AfDB, AXIAN Take Digital Finance to 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — Ecofin Agency, 4 September 2026 TANZANIA SENEGAL TOGO COMOROS

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a programme to reach 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal with loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile-money platforms, with training for 25,000 women in five countries. It follows a US$160m AfDB loan to AXIAN Telecom approved in January 2025, alongside a US$2.5m grant.

MOBILE MONEY COMPLAINTS TASK FORCE

- **Une Task Force sera mise en place pour améliorer le traitement des réclamations liées au Mobile Money** — 2424.mg, 15 September 2026

The finance ministry announced a task force on mobile money complaints, bringing the banking supervision commission and the communications regulator together to speed up resolution. Users report lost money, failed transactions and long waits.

GASY MONEY MOBILE-BANKING APP (BGFIBANK)

- **Gasy Money: BGFIBank Madagascar réinvente le mobile banking** — Newsmada, 21 September 2026

  BGFIBank Madagascar launched Gasy Money, a mobile banking app open to people without an account at the bank, including those with no bank account at all, on any mobile network. The launch date was not given. It handles deposits and withdrawals through agents, branches and ATMs, merchant and bill payments, top-ups of prepaid Visa cards, and transfers to bank accounts and Airtel Money.

- **Mobile banking : Gasy Money entre dans la course de la finance digitale** — Midi Madagasikara, 22 September 2026

  BGFIBank Madagasikara presented its Gasy Money mobile banking app at the Carlton Anosy hotel in Antananarivo, open to the bank's customers, users of other banks and people without bank accounts. The app currently allows national money transfers through partnerships with mobile operators, and manages the bank's Karatro prepaid card for international use. No fees or user targets are given.

MVOLA MOBILE MONEY PLATFORM

- **INCLUSION FINANCIÈRE - La digitalisation et les services financiers à démocratiser** — L'Express de Madagascar, 3 October 2026

  Madagascar's Mvola has made merchant payments free for customers, with the merchant bearing the fee. The mobile money operator reports close to 4 million users, more than 60,000 cashpoints and more than 50,000 merchants accepting payment.

ANTANANARIVO MARKET FEE DIGITALISATION

- **Madagascar: Commune Urbaine d'Antananarivo - Coup d'envoi de la digitalisation des marchés** — Midi Madagasikara (allAfrica), 8 October 2026

  Antananarivo's urban commune began digitalising its markets: traders are registered on tablet and issued chip and QR cards debited by collectors' payment terminals in place of paper tickets. Markets bring the commune MGA 7 to 9 billion a year.

Registries

REGISTRE SOCIAL UNIQUE (RSU)

- **Protection sociale : le RSU élargit son filet** — Newsmada, 10 September 2026

  Madagascar's single social registry, which covers about 2.7 million households or close to 12 million people, is being extended to eight more districts beyond the 20 already covered, the population ministry's director general said on 9 September 2026. A new survey is updating the data and extending coverage to urban areas, under the national social protection strategy for 2024–2030.

BIRTH REGISTRATION COVERAGE

- **ÉTAT CIVIL - 20 % des citoyens restent sans identité légale** — L'Express de Madagascar, 16 September 2026

  About 20% of Madagascar's population remains outside the civil register, L'Express reports from the National Identity Day launch in Antananarivo. Officials named biometric registration in the communes and simpler procedures at communal offices as priorities.

- **État civil : Le projet de l'OIF en renfort d'« Izaho Tokana 2.0 »** — Midi Madagasikara, 16 September 2026

  Madagascar opened a second phase of its Izaho Tokana 2.0 birth-registration drive on National Identity Day, 15 September 2026, with support from the Francophonie organisation's civil status project. The 2025 multiple indicator survey found close to 20% of children under five without a birth certificate, 21% in rural areas against about 12% in towns.

NATIONAL CENSUS AND DIGITALISATION OF COOPERATIVES

- **Sociétés-coopératives : 124 structures dotées de cartes biométriques à Analamanga** — Midi Madagasikara, 16 September 2026

  Madagascar's industrialisation ministry handed biometric cards to the first 124 registered cooperatives in Analamanga on 15 September 2026, under a UNDP-funded census building a verified national database of cooperatives. The census has also begun in Atsinanana and Analanjirofo.

CENTRAL REGISTER OF BENEFICIAL OWNERS (RCBE)

- **TRANSPARENCE – Le RCBE entre dans sa phase d'exploitation avec le croisement des données | 2424.mg - L'actualité à Madagascar en temps réel** — 2424.mg, 22 September 2026

  Madagascar's tax directorate signed four agreements on 18 September 2026 to cross-check its central register of beneficial owners against data held by the companies register, the Bianco anti-corruption bureau, the Economic Development Board and the chamber of notaries. The finance ministry said the register, launched on 16 June 2026, now moves from build to operation.

Sectoral management information systems

MIDAS MIGRATION INFORMATION AND DATA ANALYSIS SYSTEM AT BORDER POSTS

- **Projet « Créer des frontières plus intelligentes à Madagascar** — Moov Madagascar, 18 September 2026

  The International Organization for Migration's Japan-funded Smarter Borders project closed in Madagascar on 18 September 2026 after two years. It installed mobile MIDAS migration-data kits at the port of Mahajanga, trained national instructors and ran a maritime simulation with 13 institutions; Madagascar was one of four beneficiaries of the US$3 million regional programme.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ALALANA EXPORT-AUTHORISATION PLATFORM

- **COMMERCE - Les démarches d'exportation simplifiées** — L'Express de Madagascar, 22 September 2026

  Madagascar's Ministry of Commerce and Consumption began two days of training for its regional directorates on Alalana, a platform for handling export authorisation requests, at Mahamasina on 21 September 2026. Minister Andriamadison Haingotiana said it speeds up processing and makes it more transparent; vanilla and cloves are among the products covered. No launch date, cost or supplier is given.

TOROHY TAX-ADMINISTRATION CORRUPTION REPORTING PLATFORM

- **LUTTE CONTRE LA CORRUPTION - Le colonel Randrianirina appelle le fisc à sévir** — L'Express de Madagascar, 10 October 2026

  Madagascar's tax directorate launched Torohy on 9 October, a platform for the public to report corruption in the tax administration. The head of state asked for the same at customs and the treasury.

E-PASIPAORO ONLINE PASSPORT APPLICATION PORTAL

- **ADMINISTRATION – Le site de demande de passeport en ligne en cours de test, selon le ministère en charge du Développement numérique** — 2424.mg, 11 October 2026

  Madagascar's digital ministry said its online passport application portal is being tested. Applicants will be able to file, pay and track a first application, renewal or replacement online, while biometric capture and signature remain in person; no launch date was given.

Technology

ICT Industry

ASAN'AI DIGITAL AND OUTSOURCING TRAINING PROGRAMME

- **99 young people certified in BPO trades after seven-week Asanai training (Madagascar)** — 2424.mg, 24 September 2026

  Madagascar's Asanai programme certified 99 of the 111 trainees in its second seven-week cohort in business process outsourcing skills on 24 September 2026. The programme is run by the digital development ministry with World Bank support through the Integrated Growth Poles (PIC) project and delivered with ArkeUp Academy.

Capacity

Literacy

PIX DIGITAL-SKILLS CERTIFICATION PARTNERSHIP

- **Partenariat METFP et GIP Pix** — Moov.mg, 11 September 2026

  Madagascar's Ministry of Technical Education and Vocational Training and France's GIP Pix signed a partnership on 11 September 2026 to develop and certify young people's digital skills. Its eight areas include preparing learners for certification, setting up exam centres, training trainers and tracking candidates. The two will study adding Pix to the CAP, BEP and vocational and technological baccalaureate curricula.

Training and skills

VOCATIONAL TRAINING MINISTRY AND ORANGE DIGITAL-SKILLS PARTNERSHIP

- **Madagascar Partners with Orange to Strengthen Digital Skills and Vocational Training** — Tech Africa News, 14 October 2026

  Madagascar's Ministry of Technical Education and Vocational Training signed a partnership with Orange Madagascar on 8 October on digital-skills training and matching vocational courses to labour-market demand. No budget or targets were given.

Inclusion

Access to services

FONDS DECIM AFFORDABLE-DEVICE FACILITY

- **Projet « Pilote Laptop » : facilitation de l'accès aux outils numériques** — Newsmada, 8 September 2026

  Madagascar's microfinance institution Paositra Finances launched a scheme at Ankatso letting 1,400 master's students at the universities of Antananarivo and Fianarantsoa buy laptops on 12-month credit. Students pay a 20% deposit of about 210,000 ariary, then 75,000 ariary a month. The scheme draws on part of the World Bank-financed DECIM digital and energy connectivity project.

Digital divides

TELECOMS AND ICT DEVELOPMENT FUND (FDTIC)

- **Madagascar — Fonds de Développement des Télécommunications et des TIC (FDTIC) — états financiers, période du 1er janvier au 31 décembre 2024** — Autorité de Régulation des Technologies de Communication (ARTEC), for the FDTIC (Ministère du Développement Numérique, des Postes et des Télécommunications), 1 September 2026

  Madagascar's telecoms regulator ARTEC published the 2024 financial statements of the Telecommunications and ICT Development Fund, the universal-service fund it manages. The four-page statements show Ar 62.9bn in contributions received, Ar 91.3bn granted and a deficit of Ar 27.95bn for the year. Whether an auditor's opinion accompanies them is not stated.

- **Madagascar — Fonds de Développement des Télécommunications et des TIC (FDTIC) — états financiers, période du 1er janvier au 31 décembre 2025** — Autorité de Régulation des Technologies de Communication (ARTEC), for the FDTIC (Ministère du Développement Numérique, des Postes et des Télécommunications), 1 September 2026

  Madagascar's telecoms and ICT development fund (FDTIC), the universal-service fund managed by the regulator ARTEC, published its financial statements for 1 January to 31 December 2025. The fund took in Ar 100.1 billion in contributions and granted Ar 100.4 billion, close to break-even after a 2024 deficit. The file does not show whether an auditor's opinion accompanies the four pages of statements.

Data

Open data

PUBLICATION OF BUDGET INFORMATION

- **FINANCES PUBLIQUES - Les informations budgétaires accessibles au public** — L'Express de Madagascar, 8 October 2026

  Madagascar's economy and finance ministry plans to publish more budget information and widen citizen participation after an International Budget Partnership assessment of 2024-2025 scored the country below 61 out of 100. The Court of Audit says it will resume publishing the budget settlement law document in 2027, interrupted since 2020. The exact score is not given.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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